

AN INTRODUCTION

Project State.

A local-first intelligence layer for modern knowledge work.

Project State is a portable organizational memory system that captures the evolving state of a project, team, or business initiative. It stores that context inside the project itself using durable local files — YAML, Markdown, JSON — a persistent source of truth that large language models can query, summarize, and use to support execution.

§ THE PROBLEM

Modern work is *fragmented*.

A single project may span GitHub, Gmail, Slack, Jira, Confluence, SharePoint, spreadsheets, meeting notes, and informal conversations. Decisions get buried. Context disappears. Reporting becomes manual. New contributors need long onboarding. Leaders lack a reliable picture of what is actually happening.

AI tools can help, but only when they have the right context. Most teams do not have a clean, current, portable layer of project intelligence for AI to work from.

§ THE SOLUTION

A living *project state*.

Project State creates that layer. It harvests activity from distributed tools and organizes it into a living project state: goals, milestones, decisions, risks, blockers, open questions, communications, documents, reports, and stakeholder context. The result is a durable memory layer that helps people and AI understand what happened, what matters now, and what should happen next.

§ THE FOUR-LAYER STACK

01 SIGNAL	<code>work-state</code> <code>~/.work-state/</code> Harvests activity from GitHub, Gmail, Slack, and Google Drive into a structured personal activity log.	ANSWERS what has been touched, and by whom?
02 EXECUTION	<code>project-state</code> <code>./.project-state/</code> Per-project depth: milestones, phase gates, decisions, risks, document curation, IP, funder reporting.	ANSWERS how is this project actually going?
03 PORTFOLIO	<code>docket-state</code> <code>~/.docket-state/</code> Company-wide register of every project, prospect, operational stream, and concern — in one view.	ANSWERS what is the company responsible for?
04 STRATEGIC	<code>strategic-state</code> <code>~/.strategic-state/</code> A versioned, falsifiable thesis; the strategic axes it operates on; a force map linking every project to the part of the thesis it proves, stresses, or contradicts.	ANSWERS is what we're building still what we believe?

signal → execution → portfolio → strategic information flows upward · authority flows down · no layer writes back

§ BENEFITS

- 01 Reduces cognitive load by capturing context that normally lives in people's heads.
- 02 Makes work queryable across tools, files, messages, and project history.
- 03 Improves reporting with faster updates, retrospectives, summaries, and stakeholder communications.
- 04 Supports better AI execution by giving LLMs structured, current project context.
- 05 Preserves portability through local flat files that are not locked to one vendor.
- 06 Accelerates onboarding by making project history, decisions, risks, and next steps easy to access.

§ AUDIENCES

Project State is built for **founders, operators, product leads, project managers, technical teams, consultants, advisors, small teams, manufacturers**, and AI-forward organizations managing complex work across many systems.

§ POSITIONING

The missing memory layer for *AI-enabled work*.

It turns distributed project activity into structured, portable intelligence for teams that need clearer context, faster execution, and better organizational memory.